



A male flower opens, sheds pollen, and falls off within a day.



Sugar is made from the sweet sap in the stalks of the flower buds.

Flower > Coconut flower stalks contain spikes growing from a fleshy stem. Male flowers grow at the tops of the spikes, while female ones grow at their base. Both types of flowers produce nectar to attract insects.

Coconut palm

Brooms are made from the stiff, dried midribs of coconut leaves.



Coconut leaves can grow up to 6 ft (1.8 m) wide.



Baskets can be made by weaving together the leaflets of coconut leaves.

Leaf > Mature coconut palms have around 35 leaves, each of which grows from a single bud at the top of the tree. Coconut leaves can grow up to 19 3/4 ft (6 m) in length.

Other plants and their products

Cotton

White fibers surround the seeds of the cotton plant. In the wild, these fibers drift off in the wind, carrying the seeds to new places to grow. The fibers can be removed from the seeds and spun into threads to make textiles.



Thread

Hemp

This was one of the first plants to be used for clothing. The long fibers that make up the stem of the plant are used to make threads that can be woven into fabrics or twisted into string.



String

Cork oak

The waterproof outer bark of the cork oak tree is used to make stoppers for bottles, floor tiles, and many other household objects. The bark grows slowly and is harvested once a decade.



Cork stopper

Layer of bark has been removed.

Rubber

The milky sap of the rubber tree is harvested by cutting a line into its trunk and collecting the liquid that drips out. When set, rubber is an elastic material used to make gloves, shoe soles, and tires.



Tire